



Buckling escape boots over battledress trousers

Irvin flying jacket
Worn on top of the battledress, this flying jacket, made of sheepskin, kept the pilot warm at high altitudes. The large panels are characteristic of prewar designs, before shortages forced the production of multipanel variants. Though inferior in quality, the latter made better use of materials.

1943 escape boots
These 1943-pattern escape boots were made so that the leg section could be cut away if the owner came down in enemy territory. The remaining shoe section was of a civilian design to aid escape without detection. A knife was secreted in the leg.

